

Independent world

In 1945, most of the world's nations were colonies, which meant they were ruled by other countries. Since then, most colonies have become independent. Some countries gained their freedom peacefully, while others had to fight for it. There are now 195 independent nations in the world.

KEY (1945)

BELIZE 1981 Country name, with date of independence

- Britain and colonies
- France and colonies
- Denmark and colonies
- Spain and colonies
- Portugal and colonies
- The Netherlands and colonies
- Norway and colonies
- Belgium and colonies
- Japan and colonies
- Italy and colonies
- The United States and colonies
- Australia and colonies
- Independent nations



South Africa

South African laws used to keep white and black people separate in a system called apartheid. Black people were treated as less important. Nelson Mandela led people against these laws. Apartheid finally ended in 1991.